DRIP · REFERENCE 1-PAGER

TYPOLOGIES & CLASSIFICATIONS

The controlled vocabularies behind the DRIP platform — how it organises content, farm practices, results and language so everything is named, grouped and findable the same way.

v1.0 · 28 June 2026   FAO · GEF — DSL-IP   Aligned with the WOCAT global standard

DRIP uses nine interlocking classification systems. Three are **global standards** (WOCAT measures, technology groups and approaches; GEF-7 Core Indicators). The rest are **DRIP/DSL-IP conventions** that structure the library, the farm skill tree and the programme's results framework.

1 Content typology — the library

Every item in the knowledge library is one of six resource types, each also tagged with a level and a biome.

Biome primer	Sets the ecological scene for a dryland biome (Caatinga, Miombo–Mopane).
Manual	Printable good-practice manual — the DRIP Manual Series.
Practice	A named SLM/SFM technology or approach, WOCAT-classified.
Module	Self-paced knowledge & learning module.
Framework	A method or framework that structures the work (ILAM, SLPF, REM...).
Tool	Interactive tool or live dashboard (EarthMap, MARVEL, PolOpT).

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

Intro · Intermediate · Advanced

BIOME TAG

Caatinga · Miombo–Mopane · Global

2 Practice clustering — the farm skill tree

32 sustainable land-management practices grouped into 5 thematic clusters, connected by prerequisites (tiers) and earned through GPS-verified photo evidence.

Water harvesting 8 practices
Catch and store every drop of rain.

Soil & fertility 8 practices
Build deep, living, fertile soil.

Trees & agroforestry 6 practices
Bring trees back into the farm.

Crops & cropping 6 practices
Grow more, with less risk.

Livestock & fodder 4 practices
Feed the herd through the dry season.

MASTERY RANKS (BY SHARE OF XP EARNED)

Seedling · Field Hand · Practitioner · Specialist · Land Steward · Master Restorer

Difficulty mirrors the library levels (Intro · Intermediate · Advanced). Each practice also carries the full WOCAT classification below.

3 WOCAT SLM-Technologies classification

The global standard for documenting *what* a practice is. Source: WOCAT — World Overview of Conservation Approaches and Technologies (wocat.net).

MEASURES (A · V · S · M)

A **Agronomic**
Soil-surface, short-term — mulching, intercropping, manuring, contour cultivation.

V **Vegetative**
Perennial plants in alignment — trees, hedges, grass strips, windbreaks.

S **Structural**
Constructions that change the slope profile — terraces, bunds, dams, ponds.

M **Management**
Change of land use/management — rotation, area closure, grazing control, improved varieties.

TECHNOLOGY GROUPS (26)

- Agroforestry
- Area closure (stop use, support restoration)
- Beekeeping, fishfarming etc.
- Cross-slope measure
- Ecosystem-based disaster risk reduction
- Energy efficiency
- Forest plantation management
- Groundwater management
- Home gardens
- Improved ground/vegetation cover
- Improved plant varieties, animal breeds
- Integrated crop–livestock management
- Integrated pest and disease management
- Integrated soil fertility management
- Irrigation management
- Minimal soil disturbance
- Natural and semi-natural forest management
- Pastoralism and grazing land management
- Post-harvest measures
- Rotational system (rotation, fallows, shifting cultivation)
- Surface water management
- Waste / waste-water management
- Water diversion and drainage
- Water harvesting
- Wetland protection/management
- Windbreak / shelterbelt

LAND-USE TYPES (7)

- Cropland
- Grazing land
- Forest / woodlands
- Mixed
- Settlements / infrastructure
- Waterways, water bodies, wetlands
- Unproductive land

LAND DEGRADATION ADDRESSED (6)

- Soil erosion by water
- Soil erosion by wind
- Chemical soil deterioration
- Physical soil deterioration
- Biological degradation
- Water degradation

4 WOCAT SLM-Approaches classification

The companion standard for documenting *how* a practice is introduced and supported — eight documentation dimensions (see the DRIP Manual WOCAT annexes).

- General information
- Description of the Approach
- Aims & enabling / hindering conditions
- Methods, actors and roles
- Capacity building and activities
- Financing & external material support
- Impact analysis & concluding statements
- References

5 Programme frameworks

DSL-IP PILLARS (7)

- Coordination & Exchange
- Assessment & Evidence
- Sustainable Production
- Gender & Inclusion
- Monitoring & Learning
- Knowledge & Outreach
- Finance & Governance

MARVEL — THE RESULTS LAYER

- **M**onitoring
- **A**ssessment
- **R**eporting
- **V**erification
- **E**valuation
- **L**earning

MRV (results) + MEL (learning).

GEF-7 CORE INDICATORS

CI-3	Area of land restored
CI-4	Area of landscapes under improved practices
CI-6	Greenhouse-gas emissions mitigated (tCO_2e)

ASSESSMENT METHOD

ILAM — Integrated Landscape Assessment Methodology: wall-to-wall land-condition screening (productivity, fire, land cover) via FAO EarthMap, feeding the baseline.

6 Biomes in focus

Caatinga	Brazil's semi-arid seasonally-dry tropical forest — the platform's reference biome.
Miombo & Mopane	Southern Africa's great dry woodlands, where most DSL-IP child projects work.
Global	Cross-cutting, biome-independent material.

7 Acronyms & glossary

The programme's working vocabulary, expanded.

DRIP	Drylands Restoration Initiatives Platform
DSL-IP	Dryland Sustainable Landscapes Impact Program
FAO	Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations
GEF	Global Environment Facility
SLM / SFM	Sustainable Land Management / Sustainable Forest Management
WOCAT	World Overview of Conservation Approaches and Technologies
A / V / S / M	Agronomic / Vegetative / Structural / Management (WOCAT measures)
ILAM	Integrated Landscape Assessment Methodology
SLPF	Sustainable Landscape Production Framework
FFS	Farmer Field Schools
FFF	Forest and Farm Facility
FFPO	Forest and Farm Producer Organisations
CSB	Community Seed Banks

REM	Regional Exchange Mechanism
MARVEL	Monitoring, Assessment, Reporting, Verification, Evaluation and Learning
MRV / MEL	Monitoring, Reporting & Verification / Monitoring, Evaluation & Learning
GEB	Global Environmental Benefits
CI	GEF-7 Core Indicator
EX-ACT	Ex-Ante Carbon-balance Tool (FAO)
NEXT	FAO carbon-balance tool extending EX-ACT
NDVI	Normalized Difference Vegetation Index
LADA	Land Degradation Assessment in Drylands
FMNR	Farmer-Managed Natural Regeneration
SNA	Social Network Analysis
DFSA	Dryland Forest Support Accelerator
PolOpT	Policy Optimization Tool
COFO	Committee on Forestry (FAO)
UNCCD	UN Convention to Combat Desertification

About this reference. Compiled for the DRIP platform from the live classification systems used across the knowledge library, the farm skill tree and the DSL-IP results framework. Global standards follow WOCAT and the GEF-7 Core Indicators. v1.0 · 28 June 2026 · FAO / GEF — Dryland Sustainable Landscapes Impact Program.